

Universe Business Invitation Letter Process

If you need a business invitation letter to apply for your Business Visa (B-1) or entry in the US, we are pleased to provide you with the necessary letter. To request a business invitation letter please follow the following steps:

- Complete your registration for the event.
- If applicable, apply for your visa and set up your visa appointment.
- Email events@github.com with the subject line: "Letter of Invitation – attendee name"
- Include the following required information in your email:
 - Full Name as it appears on your passport

You can expect to receive your business invitation letter **within 7 business days** from the date of submission considering you provided all of the required information.

FAQ for GitHub Universe Event

Q: Do I need a visa to attend an event or conference in the United States?

A: Based on the citizenship that you hold, you may be required to obtain a Business Visitor Visa (B-1) or apply for a visa waiver, subject to your possession of citizenship with a country that is a participant in the Visa Waiver Program (VWP). Detailed business visitor requirements and can be found on the [US Department of State](#) website.

Q: What is the Visa Waiver Program (VWP)?

A: The Visa Waiver Program (VWP) enables most citizens or nationals of participating countries to travel to the US for tourism or business for stays of 90 days or less without obtaining a visa. In order to determine whether your country of citizenship is a participant in the VWP please visit the following [VWP](#) website.

If your country of citizenship is listed as a participant of the VWP, you are required to submit an Electronic Systems for Travel Authorization (ESTA) application at least 72 hours prior to any international travel inbound for the United States. If you have an ESTA previously approved, please ensure that the ESTA remains valid.

Q: What is the Business Visitor Visa (B-1)?

A: Usually, a citizen of a foreign country who wishes to enter the US must first obtain a B-1 Business Visitor Visa. Please note that B Visas require a visa appointment at your local US consulate/embassy. Please be advised that the B-1 Visa is specific to business travel which only affords the visa holder to engage in the following functions while in the US:

- Consult with business associates
- Attend a scientific, educational, professional, or business convention or conference
- Settle an estate
- Negotiate a contract

It is important to consider that B-visa travelers should not engage in day-to-day employment duties as this remains outside of the scope of approved activities that a B visa holder may conduct while in the US.

Q: Do I need a business invitation letter to receive my visa or enter the United States?

A: For B-1 visa appointments or entry into the US, you may be asked to produce documentation explaining your trip's purpose. Carrying an invitation letter is recommended as this can help establish the purpose of your visit and facilitate the visa process.

Q: What are the requirements to request a business invitation letter to attend the GitHub Universe Event?

A: In order to request a business invitation letter, you must have purchased your registration/ticket for the GitHub Universe event and received confirmation of your registration.

Q: Can I request a business invitation letter before my registration is confirmed?

A: No, the invitation letter request should be made after your registration for the GitHub Universe event has been confirmed. If your B-1 visa is not approved and you are unable to attend the event, you will receive a full refund of your registration fee if you request a refund on or before Tuesday, October 14, 2025. Unfortunately, refunds will not be possible if you submit a refund request after October 15, 2025.

Q: What should I do to complete the registration to GitHub Universe?

A: To complete your registration for Universe, go to [GitHubuniverse.com](https://githubuniverse.com). Create an account and then choose the pass type you would like to register for.

Q: When can I expect to receive my business invitation letter?

A: You can expect to receive your business invitation letter within 7 business days from the date of submission considering you provided all of the required information.

Q: How long does it take to get a Visitor Visa?

A: Wait times for interview appointments vary by location, season, and visa category. You should apply for your visa as soon as you have registered for the event. You may consult the Visa Appointment Wait Times at the Department of State [website](#).

Q: Can Github assist with emergency visa appointment requests?

A: The US State Department does not honor emergency appointments for B-1 visa applications. GitHub is unable to support the pursuit of emergency visa appointment requests.

Q: During the B-1 visa application process if I need to provide a point of contact in the US who should I list?

A: US Point of Contact:

Name	Michelle Sussumo
Title	Immigration and Global Mobility Manager
Organization	GitHub, Inc.
Email	mobility@github.com
Address	10900 NE 4th St. Ste 2100, Bellevue, WA 98004
General phone number	415-735-4488

Q: Who should I contact if I have additional questions?

A: If you have a question not covered in the FAQ's above, please contact us at events@github.com.